Maritime transport of goods at port level - quarterly data

Statistics Explained

Data extracted in September 2026
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Highlights

Rotterdam continues to lead the EU in port activity, with 97.8 million tonnes of goods handled in Q4 2025.

This article presents quarterly statistics on maritime transport of goods in the European Union (EU) ports . It covers the gross weight of goods handled in the main EU ports , by type of cargo.

The article contains data for Q4 2025. Please note that the quarterly port activity figures are provisional and subject to revision.

Rotterdam remained the EU port with the highest activity

Rotterdam was by far the EU port with the highest activity in Q4 2025, with 97.8 million tonnes of gross weight of goods handled (Figure 1).

The second main port was Antwerp-Bruges, which handled 56.1 million tonnes. The third port was Hamburg with 24.5 million tonnes. The fourth and fifth ports were HAROPA and Amsterdam, with 21.0 million tonnes and 20.7 million tonnes, respectively.

HAROPA registered the largest increase by 10.3% compared with Q4 2024. In the same period, 2 other ports in the top 5 increased: Amsterdam by 2.7% and Hamburg by 1.1%. On the opposite end, Antwerp-Bruges recorded the highest decrease (-4.2%), followed by Rotterdam (-0.7%).

Over the last 4 quarters, compared with the previous 4, 3 ports of the top 5 decreased: Antwerp-Bruges by 4.2%, Rotterdam by 1.8% and Amsterdam by 0.3%. By contrast, Hamburg increased by 2.9% and HAROPA by 1.8%.

Figure 1When looking at liquid bulk, Rotterdam was by far the main EU port in Q4 2025, followed by Antwerp-Bruges, Marseille, Trieste and Amsterdam (Figure 2).

The only port to see a decrease compared with the same quarter of the previous year was Antwerp-Bruges (-8.3%). By contrast, Amsterdam registered the largest increase by 23.4%, followed by Trieste (+10.7%), Marseille (+2.5%), and Rotterdam (+1.2%).

When the latest 4 quarters are compared with the previous 4, Marseille increased by 7.6%, Trieste by 4.6%, and Amsterdam by 1.9%. By contrast, Antwerp-Bruges decreased by 11.4% and Rotterdam by 1.0%.

Figure 2When looking at dry bulk, Rotterdam was again the main EU port in Q4 2025, followed by Amsterdam, Zeeland Seaports, Constanta, and Hamburg (Figure 3).

Compared with the same quarter of 2024, 3 ports of the top 5 increased: Zeeland Seaports by 40.4%, Constanta by 10.5%, and Hamburg by 0.9%. On the opposite end, Amsterdam and Rotterdam substantially decreased by 14.2% and 9.3%, respectively.

Over the last 4 quarters, compared with the previous 4, only Zeeland Seaports increased (+13.5%) while Constanta

registered the largest decrease (-7.6%), followed by Rotterdam (-5.4%), Hamburg (-3.6%), and Amsterdam (-2.8%).

Figure 3In the large container cargo segment, Antwerp-Bruges remained the main EU port in Q4 2025, followed by Rotterdam. Hamburg, Gioia Tauro, and Valencia completed the top 5 EU ports (Figure 4).

Compared with the same quarter of the previous year, 3 out of the 5 ports increased. The largest increase was registered by Gioia Tauro (+31.0%), followed by Hamburg (+4.2%) and Rotterdam (+0.5%). By contrast, Valencia decreased by 3.0% and Antwerp-Bruges by 1.4%.

When the latest 4 quarters are compared with the previous 4, Gioia Tauro increased by 12.8%, Hamburg by 5.8%, and Antwerp-Bruges by 0.2%. By contrast, Rotterdam decreased by 0.5% and Valencia by 2.2%.

Figure 4When looking at the number of twenty-foot equivalent units (TEUs) handled in the same period (Figure 5), the ranking was different to the one based on tonnes of containerised goods. Indeed, Rotterdam took the first place in front of Antwerp-Bruges. Moreover, Algeciras enters the ranking at the 4th place in front of Valencia.

Compared with the same quarter of 2024, 4 out of the 5 ports increased in Q4 2025: Algeciras (+12.3%), Hamburg (+6.5%), Rotterdam (+3.1%), and Valencia (+2.0%). By contrast, Antwerp-Bruges decreased by 1.0%.

Over the last 4 quarters, compared with the previous 4, Hamburg recorded the highest increase (+9.3%), followed by Algeciras (+4.0%), Rotterdam (+3.4%), Valencia (+2.8%), and Antwerp-Bruges (+0.7%).

Figure 5When looking at the tonnage of Ro-Ro mobile units, the picture is different compared with the other types of cargo. Antwerp-Bruges was the largest EU Ro-Ro port in Q4 2025. It was followed by Rotterdam, Calais, Dublin and Lübeck (Figure 6).

Compared with the same quarter of 2024, 3 out of the 5 ports increased. Dublin recorded the highest increase by 7.3%, followed by Lübeck (+2.5%) and Rotterdam (+1.7%). On the opposite, Calais decreased by 2.2% and Antwerp-Bruges by 0.4%.

When the latest 4 quarters are compared with the previous 4, Calais (-1.4%) and Dublin (-0.1%) decreased while Lübeck increased by 2.4%, Antwerp-Bruges by 0.6%, and Rotterdam by 0.5%.

Figure 6

Data sources and availability

The content of this statistical article is based on data collected within the framework of the EU maritime transport statistics Directive 2009/42/EC on statistical returns in respect of carriage of goods and passengers by sea.

Data are presented at the level of ' statistical ports '. A statistical port consists of 1 or more ports, normally controlled by a single port authority, able to record ship and cargo movements. All figures are based on a port's total (inward + outward) declarations. The results represent the 'handling' of goods in ports.

Type of cargo : the following 13 cargo types are used: liquefied gas, crude oil, oil products, other liquid bulk goods, ores, coal, agricultural products, other dry bulk goods, large containers, Ro-Ro mobile units, forestry products, iron/steel products and other general cargo. The first 4 types constitute 'liquid bulk', the subsequent 4 types 'dry bulk' and the last 3 types 'other general cargo not elsewhere specified'.

Abbreviations

Quarterly data are in general provisional. Revisions may be made by countries as more complete information becomes available or as a result of quality checks. More specifically, when the complete set of annual data emerges, this usually involves some revision of quarterly data for some countries.

Annual data as presented in this publication are the rolling 4 quarter totals ending in the latest quarter and the corresponding 4 quarters for earlier years. As a result, the 4 quarters included do not necessarily come from the same calendar year. For example, the 'annual' change rate in Figure 1 shows the percentage change for the 4 quarters ending in the 4th quarter of 2025 compared with the 4 quarters ending in the 4th quarter of 2024. The basic results (in million tonnes) and the derived indicators (growth rates) shown in the figures are rounded. However, they are all based on non-rounded original data, as available in Eurostat's database.

:	not available
-	not applicable
Nes	Not elsewhere specified
Ro-Ro	Roll-on/roll-off
TEU	Twenty-foot Equivalent Unit

Specific remarks for data up to and including Q4 2025:

- Starting from Q1 2022, the ports Antwerpen and Zeebrugge have been merged and the data are reported under the new port name Antwerp-Bruges.
- Starting from Q1 2022, the ports Le Havre and Rouen have been merged and the data are reported under the new port name HAROPA.

Due to revisions of the underlying data, figures in this article may differ from figures currently or previously available on Eurostat's website.

Context

The content of this statistical article is based on data collected within the framework of the EU maritime transport statistics Directive 2009/42/EC of 6 May 2009 on statistical returns in respect of carriage of goods and passengers by sea, which is a recast of the original Council Directive 95/64/EC of 8 December 1995.

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- Maritime transport (ESMS metadata file — mar_esms)
- Reference Manual on Maritime Transport Statistics
- Glossary for transport statistics - 6th edition - 2026

Legislation

The basic legal act (Directive 2009/42/EC) has been amended by:

- Summaries of EU legislation: Statistical returns in respect of carriage of goods and passengers by sea
- Commission Decision 2010/216/EU of the EP and of the Council of 14 April 2010, OJ L 94, 15.4.2010, p. 33-40
- Regulation (EU) No 1090/2010 of the EP and of the Council of 24 November 2010, OJ L 325, 9.12.2010, p. 1-3
- Commission Delegated Decision 2012/186/EU of 3 February 2012 OJ L 101 of 11.4.2012, p. 5-14.

The following legal acts include the last official version of the list of ports and some dissemination aspects, respectively:

- Commission Decision 2001/423/EC of 22 May 2001 (on dissemination) OJ L 151 of 07.06.2001 p. 41
- Commission Delegated Decision (EU) 2018/1007 of 25 April 2018 supplementing Directive 2009/42/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council as regards the list of ports and repealing Commission Decision 2008/861/EC (Text with EEA relevance.), OJ L 180, 17.7.2018, p. 29–71